GOVERNMENT OF INDIA

Ministry of Education

Empowering Minds to Shape a Developed India



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SHRI NARENDRA MODI

HONORABLE PRIME MINISTER, INDIA



MESSAGE

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MESSAGE

Education is the foundation of national development, innovation, social progress, and economic prosperity. As India prepares to become a global knowledge economy, the Ministry of Education plays a transformative role in strengthening learning systems, promoting research and innovation, developing future-ready skills, enhancing institutional excellence, and nurturing human capital capable of driving sustainable growth.

The Chamber of Commerce and Industries of India (CCI India) believes that stronger collaboration between educational institutions, industry, government, startups, research organizations, and investors is essential for creating an education ecosystem that aligns with the evolving needs of the economy. Through policy advocacy, industry-academia partnerships, skill development initiatives, innovation platforms, entrepreneurship promotion, and research commercialization, CCI India remains committed to supporting the Ministry's vision for educational excellence.

This Knowledge Paper provides an in-depth perspective on the Ministry's policy framework, flagship initiatives, institutional reforms, digital education strategies, research priorities, and emerging opportunities for collaboration. It explores key areas including higher education, school education, vocational learning, educational technology, innovation ecosystems, startup incubation, industry-integrated curricula, and international academic partnerships.

Prepared as a strategic reference for policymakers, educators, universities, research institutions, industry leaders, startups, investors, development organizations, and students, the publication seeks to foster informed dialogue and collaborative initiatives that strengthen India's education ecosystem and improve learning outcomes.

As India advances towards becoming a global centre of knowledge, innovation, and research, education will remain the cornerstone of national transformation. CCI India remains committed to working alongside the Ministry of Education in building an inclusive, technology-enabled, and globally competitive education system that empowers future generations and contributes to the realization of **Viksit Bharat 2047**.

Munindra Kumar
Director General
CCI India

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Preface

Education stands at the foundation of every nation's growth trajectory. In India, no other sector commands the same breadth of social impact, economic consequence, and civilisational significance as education. With over 265 million school-going children, more than 43 million students enrolled in higher education, and a demographic structure that places approximately 65 percent of its population below the age of 35, India's educational ecosystem is not merely a public service it is a national strategic asset of the highest order.

The Ministry of Education, Government of India, bears the constitutional and institutional responsibility of shaping this asset. Through its two principal departments the Department of School Education and Literacy, and the Department of Higher Education the Ministry oversees a network of institutions, schemes, and programmes that collectively touch the lives of hundreds of millions of Indians. The National Education Policy 2020, which represents the most comprehensive reform in Indian education since 1986, is the Ministry's defining mandate for this decade. Its implementation holds the key to India's vision of becoming a global knowledge superpower by 2047.

This Knowledge Paper has been commissioned and prepared by the Chamber of Commerce and Industry of India (CCI India) with a singular purpose: to provide a rigorous, data-driven, consulting-grade analysis of the Ministry of Education's strategic landscape, emerging opportunities, institutional gaps, and collaboration potential. The paper is designed to position CCI India as the most credible and capable strategic partner for the Ministry across the domains of policy facilitation, capacity building, investment promotion, innovation ecosystems, industry-institution linkages, and programme implementation.

The intended audience for this document includes Union Ministers, Secretaries to the Government of India, senior officials of NITI Aayog, development finance institutions, bilateral and multilateral agencies, industry leaders, and institutional investors operating in the Indian education space. The paper has been structured to serve both as a strategic briefing document and as an engagement framework for meaningful dialogue between government, industry, and civil society on education reform.

CCI India recognises that the transformation of India's education sector cannot be achieved by government alone. The scale of the challenge demands the active, structured, and sustained participation of industry, startups, investors, global institutions, and civil society. CCI India is uniquely positioned to broker, facilitate, and sustain these partnerships at the national level.

This paper reflects CCI India's commitment to building an India that learns better, innovates faster, and grows stronger a Viksit Bharat powered by knowledge.

Chamber of Commerce and Industry (CCI India)

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About CCI India

CCI India (The Chamber of Commerce and Industry of India) is a premier national business chamber dedicated to fostering economic growth, industry development, entrepreneurship, innovation, and investment promotion across India. As the voice of Indian business and industry, CCI India serves as a bridge between government, industry, startups, academia, investors, and civil society, facilitating meaningful collaboration for nation-building and sustainable development.

Through policy advocacy, business facilitation, research, stakeholder engagement, capacity building, and strategic partnerships, CCI India works to create an enabling environment for enterprises of all sizes. The Chamber actively supports key national initiatives such as Startup India, Make in India, Digital India, Atmanirbhar Bharat, Skill India, and Viksit Bharat 2047 by connecting innovative enterprises with government opportunities and promoting inclusive economic development.

CCI India operates through sector-specific councils, industry forums, knowledge platforms, and state-level engagements that address emerging opportunities and challenges across sectors including manufacturing, agriculture, technology, healthcare, education, infrastructure, sustainability, MSMEs, and startups. The Chamber regularly organizes policy dialogues, investment summits, business delegations, workshops, conferences, and knowledge-sharing initiatives to strengthen India's economic ecosystem.

With a strong commitment to innovation, entrepreneurship, and public-private collaboration, CCI India strives to empower enterprises, facilitate investment, enhance competitiveness, and contribute to India's journey toward becoming a globally competitive and economically resilient nation. Its role as a knowledge partner and industry catalyst enables ministries, departments, state governments, startups, and businesses to collaborate effectively in achieving national development objectives.

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SECTION 1 Introduction to the Ministry of Education

1.1 Constitutional and Institutional Mandate

Education is a Concurrent List subject under the Seventh Schedule of the Constitution of India, meaning both the Union and State governments hold legislative authority over it. However, the Union Government exercises overarching coordinative and standard-setting authority through the Ministry of Education (MoE), formerly known as the Ministry of Human Resource Development (MHRD) until its renaming in July 2020 a change that itself reflected the Government's philosophical pivot from resource management to holistic human capacity building.

The Ministry derives its authority from Articles 21A (Right to Education), 45 (Early Childhood Care and Education), 46 (Promotion of Educational and Economic Interests of Weaker Sections), and 350A (Instruction in Mother Tongue) of the Constitution of India. These provisions collectively assign to the State both the duty and the power to universalise quality education, ensure equitable access, and protect the right to learn in one's mother tongue mandates that the Ministry operationalises through its policies, schemes, and institutional frameworks.

1.2 Evolution of the Ministry

The Ministry of Education has evolved through several transformative phases since India's independence. Established in 1947 as the Ministry of Education, it was merged with the Ministry of Social Welfare in 1985 to form the Ministry of Human Resource Development (MHRD) under the Rajiv Gandhi government a merger intended to create a unified human development mandate. In 2020, the Ministry was renamed back to the Ministry of Education, signalling a sharper focus on the educational mandate and a deliberate departure from the broader HRD framing.

This evolution mirrors the changing paradigm of Indian education policy from literacy and access in the early decades, to quality and inclusion in the 1980s–2000s, and now to innovation, equity, internationalisation, and technology integration in the 2020s under the NEP 2020 framework.

The Ministry plays four distinct governance roles. As a policy architect, it formulates national education policy frameworks including NEP 2020, the National Curriculum Frameworks, and regulatory guidelines. As a funding authority, it disbursed over ₹1,28,650 crore in FY 2025–26, making it one of the largest spending ministries in the Union Budget. As a standard-setter, it oversees UGC, AICTE, and the National Council for Teacher Education, which collectively regulate over 1,355 universities and 52,321 colleges. And as an institutional guardian, it directly manages the IITs, IIMs, NITs, IISERs, central universities, Kendriya Vidyalayas, and Navodaya Vidyalayas institutions that collectively shape India's intellectual and innovation capital.

The Ministry's national significance transcends its administrative functions. Education is the single most powerful lever for social mobility, economic productivity, and national competitiveness. A one percent improvement in India's Gross Enrolment Ratio (GER) at the higher education level translates into approximately 500,000 additional skilled citizens entering the workforce. At the school level, universalising foundational literacy and numeracy the core goal of the NIPUN Bharat Mission could add between 1.5 and 2.5 percentage points to India's long-term GDP growth trajectory, as estimated by the World Bank's Human Capital Index research.

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